General rule – combat actions · "Playing the Game" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

On your turn you can **move** and take **one action**. You can also take a **Bonus Action** (one per turn, if a feature allows) and, off your turn, a **Reaction** (one per round). The standard actions are: Attack, Dash, Disengage, Dodge, Help, Hide, Search, Ready, Utilize, Magic, Study and Influence.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. One **action** per turn, plus movement.
2. Bonus Action: **only** if a feature grants it; one per turn.
3. Reaction: **one per round**, it resets at the start of your turn.
4. You can split your movement before and after your action.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 now lists **Study**, **Influence**, **Utilize** and **Magic** among the actions, and clarifies Dodge, Help and Hide.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

"Action" and "Reaction" are confusing next to class features. Fix: announce "action", "Bonus Action" or "Reaction" for every effect.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the action in one sentence ("you duck behind the crate") to keep the turn moving.

Step 1 – Move:

Move up to your **Speed**, before, during or after your action. Difficult terrain: each foot costs double.

Step 2 – Choose the action:

One only: Attack, Dash (extra movement equal to Speed), Disengage (no Opportunity Attacks this turn), Dodge, etc.

Step 3 – Bonus Action (if available):

Only if a spell or feature grants it. One per turn, even if several features offer it.

Step 4 – Free interaction:

One object interaction (open a door, draw a weapon) is free each turn; a second needs the Utilize action.

Step 5 – Reaction off turn:

Opportunity Attack, readied action or reaction spell. It resets at the start of your next turn.

Example: Mira (rogue) moves 20 ft, uses Disengage as a Bonus Action (Cunning Action) then attacks: the goblin can't make an Opportunity Attack against her.

Action	Effect
Attack	One attack (or more with Extra Attack); Grapple, Shove or Unarmed Strike.
Dash	Extra movement equal to your Speed this turn.
Disengage	Your movement doesn't provoke Opportunity Attacks for the rest of the turn.
Dodge	Disadvantage on attacks against you (if you see the attacker); Advantage on Dex saves.
Help	Advantage on an ally's ability check, or on their next attack against a target within 5 ft of you.
Hide	DC 15 Dexterity (Stealth) check; you need cover or heavy obscurement.
Search	Wisdom check (Insight, Medicine, Perception or Survival).
Ready	Pick a trigger and an action; it uses your Reaction.
Utilize	Use an object that needs an action.
Magic	Cast a spell or use a magic item.
Study	Intelligence check (Arcana, History, Investigation, Nature, Religion).
Influence	Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, Performance, Persuasion) or Wisdom (Animal Handling) check.

⚠ Common questions:

Can I take two actions?

No: one per turn, except specific features (Action Surge, Second Wind).

Can I move between attacks?

Yes: movement can be split.

How many Bonus Actions?

One per turn.

What is Dash?

Extra movement equal to your Speed (after modifiers).

Can a Reaction be reused?

Only after the start of your next turn.

Can I Help from a distance?

For an attack: the enemy must be within 5 ft of you.

Is Hide guaranteed?

No: DC 15 check and you stop being Invisible once noticed.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Object interaction

One free interaction; open two doors? **Option**: the DM may allow a second if it's simple.

Dash with no movement

Dash with Speed 0 does nothing. **Option**: keep it.

Improvised action

The DM may accept an unlisted action (flip a table). **Option**: ask for a check.

Reaction vs Bonus Action

They are separate and stack. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Ready

You choose a perceivable trigger; the action is taken as a Reaction and you lose your Reaction.

Readied spell

A readied spell needs concentration and its slot is spent immediately.

Dodge

Lost if you are Incapacitated or your Speed drops to 0.

Help

Advantage lasts until the start of your next turn.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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